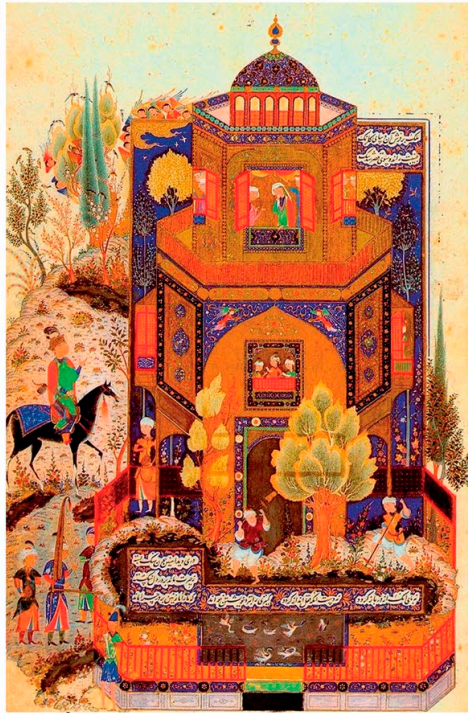


1354

TRAVELS OF IBN BATTUTA

Born in Tangier, Morocco, Muslim scholar Ibn Battuta was a tireless voyager. For 30 years he roamed the Islamic world, travelling from East Africa to Sumatra, from Sri Lanka to Samarkand, and from Jerusalem to Beijing. He published a famous account of his journeys after returning home to Morocco in 1354.



△ Ibn Battuta visits Tabriz, Iran

Ibn Battuta
travelled 117,000
km (73,000 miles)
in journeys over
three decades

1351 The Red Turban revolt

sees peasant guerrillas lead a Chinese rebellion against the Mongol Yuan dynasty

1356 The Battle of Poitiers sees an English victory over the French in the Hundred Years's War

1359

1355 The Bohemian king Charles IV is crowned Holy Roman Emperor

1356 The Chinese city of Nanjing falls to the Red Turban rebels

1358 The Jacquerie, a French peasant revolt, is brutally suppressed by the nobility

1336

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

In 1336, Harihara I established an independent empire in the Deccan region of southern India. Centred on the city of Vijayanagar ("City of Victory"), this empire lasted for more than two centuries. It became prosperous through commerce, including intercontinental trade as far as the Mediterranean. By around 1500, its capital was one of the largest cities in India, embellished by palaces and Hindu temples that are considered architectural masterpieces.

◁ Virupaksha Temple in the ruins of the ancient Vijayanagara city

